maximum nutritional benefit at minimum cost. For example, pulses can be used as a source of protein instead of animal foods or less expensive cuts of meat can be used. For achieving economy in meal planning, the following considerations are important.

1. Knowledge of prevailing prices of food items.
2. Knowledge of proportion of edible portion of different food stuffs as they vary widely. It may be high as 100 percent in foods likemilk or low as 35-40 percent in leafy vegetables. This helps to decide the quantity of food to be purchased.

a. Likes and dislikes

The meal planned should not only meet RDA but also individual preference, particularly vegetarian or non- vegetarian preferences. The likes and dislikes of all the family members should be kept in mind.If a person does not like greens, it can be tried in a different form or substituted by some other equally nourishing food. Food habits, religion, traditions,and customs of the individual should be considered in planning the menu.



Meal planning helps to ensure nutritious meals according to personal likes / dislikes

3. Buying foods from fair price shops and retail outlets.
4. Bulk purchase of non-perishables.
5. Using seasonal foods as they are not only economical but also nutritious.
6. Minimizing nutrient losses during preparation and cooking.
7. Making proper use of left over foods and the commonly discarded foods e.g. green leaves of vegetables like radish leaves.

3. Acceptability of meals

Acceptability of meals is as important as meeting nutritional needs or planning within the budget. To make meals acceptable the following considerations are important.

b. Variety

The meal should have variety in colour, texture, taste andflavor for better acceptability. Variety can be achieved by

- selecting foods from each food group
- including a variety of vegetables to add colour
- avoid repeating the same food in different meals as well in the same meal in a different form.
- use different methods of cooking such as baking, boiling, frying to bring variety in texture.
- use alternative garnishes and accompaniments.

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